Igor Feofilaktov

Senior software engineer
Platform & Developer Productivity

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Work Experience

Nov 2025 – Present **Yandex**, *Senior software engineer*, Advertising technologies, Ads Runtime Infrastructure Group

Platform engineering for a large-scale ads retrieval service: deployment tooling, infrastructure-as-code and change safety.

- Main contributor to a Go deployment-spec generator (Starlark/ytt, Helm/kustomize-like), taking it from an AI-generated prototype to a production-ready tool: reworked parts of the architecture and the code organization, and added user-facing features such as Starlark extensions. Led its adoption in the ads retrieval service: about 60 services across 160+ deployment stages moved to it.
- Owned change safety for the tool and the specs it generates:
  - Pre-merge diff tests for tool developers: every tool change is checked against all user specs.
  - Diff tests for users, enabled out of the box: spec changes and cluster quota impact are visible on every pull request.
  - Versioned feature flags with stable/prestable/testing channels, so opt-in features reach users in one release cycle.
- Made every infrastructure change of the retrieval service visible at review time with mandatory spec diff tests in CI, and moved all services to plain Kubernetes-based infrastructure-as-code with zero diff verified by tests.
- On-call: ran release rollouts, load drills and capacity changes; mitigated and analysed incidents and traced recurring ones to root causes; reworked alerting as code for cleaner, more actionable alerts.

Nov 2021 – Oct 2025 **Yandex**, *Senior software engineer*, Advertising technologies, Ads testing & release infrastructure

Main developer of the acceptance platform for the core C++ ad server (traffic-replay diff, performance and sanitizer testing), used daily by 200+ engineers for pre-merge checks, A/B-experiment validation and release acceptance. From late 2023, led the platform's planning: its documentation, stability and SDK migration projects, the 2024 roadmap, and delegation of a growing share of the work.

- Gave every change faster feedback: pre-merge check 5 h → 3 h without losing feature coverage; A/B-experiment test data 24 h → 3 h old; sanitizer and stability checks several hours faster.
- Cut the SLO for the time-to-production KPI from about 2 days to under 15 h (p90 target ≤12 h), with alerting and on-call dashboards.
- Made tests production-faithful and trustworthy: configuration overrides go through an emulator of the production dynamic-config system (equivalence verified on 23k+ test cases); wider regression checks, including memory-regression thresholds agreed with the ad-server team; the platform's reliability goal met for two consecutive half-years.
- Led the migration of all pre-merge checks to the company-wide monorepo CI and retired a legacy task SDK; designed a component-based test-harness framework, so new production microservices join acceptance tests in days, with full coverage.
- Owned the migration plan to the company's shared diff and performance testing platform: proof of concept on HashiCorp Nomad/LXC, then production-ready checks run in parallel with the legacy ones to prove parity.

Apr 2018 – Oct 2021 **Yandex**, *Software engineer*, Advertising technologies, QA&Release infrastructure team

Developed reliable differential tests for the Ads engine with self-updating test data gathered from the production environment. Improved QA&Release processes:

- Tripled the number of releases per week by automating the acceptance process.
- Increased accuracy of load differential tests by 2 times.
- Improved testing infrastructure stability and availability by setting up monitoring and alerting system.

Aug 2017 – Apr 2018 **Yandex**, *Software engineer*, Advertising technologies, Statistics infrastructure team

Designed and implemented distributed system for availability monitoring of advertisers' websites. Decreased average reaction time from 24 hours to 1 hour.

Dec 2016 – Jul 2017 **New Cloud Technologies**, *QA automation engineer*, Mail platform developing team

Built automated testing framework from the ground up. Integrated QA processes into the CI/CD system.

- Wrote automated tests for service's API.
- Designed issue tracker workflows for bug tracking issues, feature requests and releases.

Sep 2015 – Nov 2016 **Search portal Sputnik**, *QA automation engineer*, Mail developing team

Automated functional and regression tests for service backend.

- Implemented automated tests for components of the system
- Designed and implemented web-service aimed to help the manual testers set up their test environment.

May 2014 – Aug 2015 **Internet-Initiatives Development Fund**, *Tech support engineer*, IT team

Solved wide range of problems including:

- Set up Zabbix monitoring system for network devices and production services.
- Automated routine tasks such as parsing web pages to organize data for easier analysis in MS Excel.
- Automated manual tests for company's website using Selenium web driver framework.

Education

2009-2014 **Specialist in Mathematics**, *Lomonosov Moscow State University, Moscow, Russia*

Programming languages

Advanced level: python

Basic level: SQL, C++, Bash, Perl

Skills

Testing tools	pytest, allure	VCS	git, mercurial
Monitoring Tools	zabbix, grafana, Yandex internal monitoring systems	Development Tools	vim, ipython, gdb, UNIX tools
CI/CD	Jenkins, Yandex internal CI/CD system	Other	RESTful, RPC, Microservice architecture

Languages

Russian native

English high intermediate